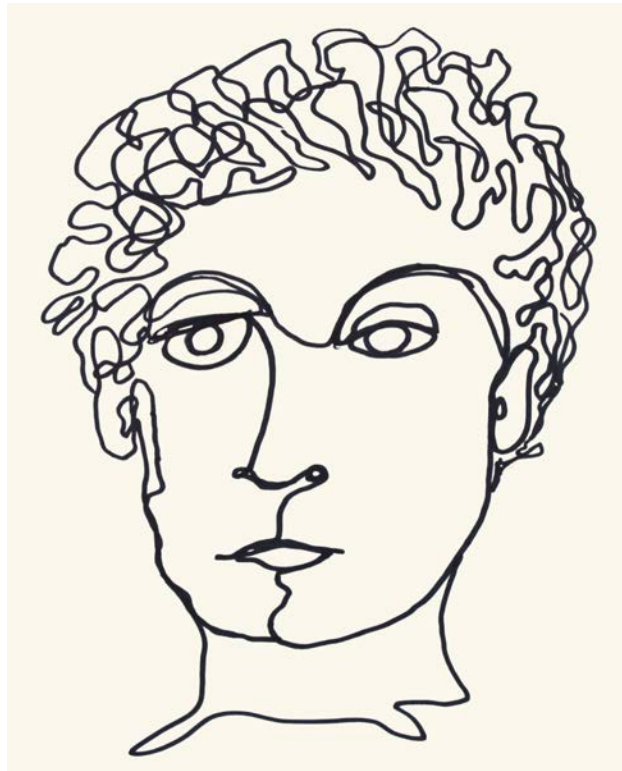




Heads & Faces

Grade 5
Drawing



Los Altos School District • 201 Covington Road • Los Altos • CA • 94024 • 650.947.1195
www.losaltosartdocents.org

Last Revised: June 2024

HEADS & FACES

Length: 60 minutes

Number of docents: 1

Purpose:

- To familiarize students with the structure and facial proportions of the human head.
- To help students learn HOW TO SEE through careful observation.
- To help students learn HOW TO DRAW what they see using the continuous line and blind continuous line techniques.

Academic Support: reinforces mathematical proportion course of studies

Visual Arts Standards:

- Combine ideas to generate an innovative idea for art-making. (5.VA:Cr1.1)
- Identify and demonstrate diverse methods of artistic investigation to choose an approach for beginning a work of art. (5.VA:Cr1.2)
- Experiment and develop skills in multiple art-making techniques and approaches through practice. (5.VA:Cr2.1)
- Demonstrate quality craftsmanship through care for and use of materials, tools, and equipment. (5.VA:Cr2.2)
- Use art vocabulary to describe personal choices in artmaking and in creating artist statements. (5.VA:Cr3)
- Compare one's own interpretation of a work of art with the interpretation of others. (5.VA:Re7.1)

Unit Contains: Supply bag and portfolio

Materials docent will bring:

- Drawing booklet
- Pen (fine-tip, black)
- Tracing paper clipped to a laminated picture of a face
- Pen shield (6" square of paper)
- Oval templates
- Poster of head with proportional lines
- Noses and mouths poster
- Eye samples
- Continuous Line poster
- Blind Continuous Line poster
- Handout of proportions of the head

Materials teacher will provide:

- Pencils

Featured works:

<i>Portrait de Françoise Gilot</i> , 1946	Pablo Picasso
<i>Françoise with a Bow in Her Hair</i> , 1946	Pablo Picasso
<i>Françoise Gilot</i> Photograph, c. 1952	Robert Doisneau
<i>The Dog</i> , 1969	Pablo Picasso
<i>Multiple Exposure of Pablo Picasso Making a Light Drawing in the Air</i> , 1949	Gjon Mili
<i>Or the Mocked Mockers</i> , 1930	Paul Klee
<i>Medusa</i> , 1930	Alexander Calder
<i>One Line Miyazaki</i>	Christophe Louis Quibe
<i>Hayao Miyazaki</i> , 2014	Stock Photograph

Room Set-up: Distribute drawing pad, pen, oval template, and proportion of the head handout to each student. Hand out the laminated pictures with tracing paper attached. Display the other charts and sample drawings.

INTRODUCTION & DISCUSSION (15 minutes)

Contour drawing is arguably the purest form of drawing – nothing but pure line. They can be incredibly simple, or presented as complex three-dimensional renditions. Most of us begin contour drawing instinctively, simply by picking a point on the edge of an object and copying it onto our paper, hand following eye.

Today we are going to try making continuous line contour and blind continuous line drawings ourselves. As the names imply, this technique means we will draw our subjects with one unbroken line, lifting our pens off the page only when our drawings are complete. This may sound simple, but it takes a lot of concentration. A common problem is that as we focus on one small area, the proportions of our subject can become distorted. The best way to solve this is to learn to think about the proportions of our subject first.

In many ways, it is an exercise about seeing rather than drawing. Many artists use the technique as a means of warming up and getting past creative stumbling blocks by seeing what is before them without allowing their rational mind to interfere with the process. The end result is more fluid and emotional than a sketch would be.

First let's take a look at some line drawings and a photograph:



Portrait de Françoise Gilot



Françoise with a Bow in Her Hair



Françoise Gilot

Suggested Dialog: (as a class or table share)

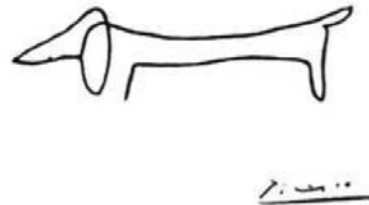
Discuss how these drawings are the same or different from the photograph.

Is it exactly like her? Why/why not?

Are the drawings realistic and life like?

These two line drawing portraits were drawn by the artist Pablo Picasso and this is a photograph of the woman he portrayed. Picasso was fascinated by the idea of reducing images to simple outlines that captured the absolute essence of what he saw.

Docent to show “The Dog” and paraphrase: Continuous line drawings were especially favored by Picasso in his later years. His use of continuous line drawings were studies in simplicity. He would draw animals – such as this portrait of his beloved dachshund, Lump – in one continuous stroke. The resulting images were uncomplicated and free from extraneous detail yet still instantly recognizable.



Docent to show multiple exposure photograph and paraphrase: This is a photography of Pablo Picasso taken by a photographer named Gjon Mili for an article in *LIFE Magazine*. Mili and Picasso teamed up to make an incredible series of photographs of Picasso “painting” with light. These were blind continuous line drawings made in the dark using a really long camera exposure and a flashlight. Neither Picasso nor Mili had any idea what the images they created looked like until AFTER the photographer was able to print the images (at the time in 1949 there were no screens on the backs of cameras). This photograph shows what can be done with patience, courage, imagination and just ONE line!



Here are some other examples of continuous line portraiture:



*Or the Mocked
Mocker*



Medusa



*One Line
Miyazaki*



Hayao Miyazaki

Suggested Dialog: (*as a class or table share*)

How would you describe line in these pieces?

What has the artist removed/kept in his image?

Are the pieces realistic and life like?

Do the lines convey emotion?

DEMONSTRATION

Before we try continuous line drawing for ourselves, let's begin by drawing a head with realistic proportions. As with all of the artists whose work we just examined, it is helpful to be classically trained before we try something different. There are rules that artists have discovered about the proportions of heads that allow them to make their drawings more realistic and we are going to draw these on the front cover of your sketchbooks. First, let's start by writing your name on the back.

1. STRUCTURE OF THE FACE (*cover of sketchbook, 10 minutes*)

Docent to demonstrate on board. Students should do each part after docent.

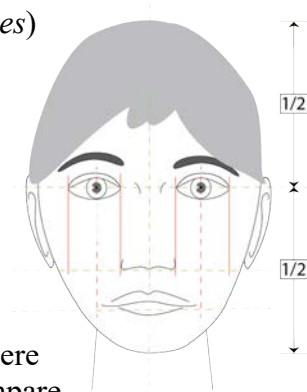
FACE: Basically, heads are oval-shaped. To begin, let's trace an oval on our sketchbook covers using the oval templates.

Docent to trace a large oval on board.

With pencil, measure on your own head the distance from inside corner of eye to the bottom of chin. Mark with your thumb where chin hits the pencil. Hold that measurement, raise pencil and compare first distance (eye level to chin) with distance from eye level to top of head (feel across from end of pencil to topmost part of head). The two distances are approximately the same!

If it is easier, you may hold your pencil up in front of you and measure the head of the person seated across/next to you.

The average head is divided into two equal parts. Upper half reaches to top of scalp; lower half to point of chin. *Draw horizontal line through center.*



Faces are also symmetrical – the features on the left side of the vertical axis that runs down your nose are reflected on the right-hand side. *Draw a vertical line through the center.*

EYES: The line dividing head into two equal parts passes through the corners of the eyes. The distance between the eyes = the width of an eye = width of nose! The eye has upper and lower lids. Lashes are attached to the lids. Not all of eyeball shows – the lids cover it in part. *Do not show chart on eye and draw the eyes on the center horizontal line.*



EYEBROWS: Draw a line over each eye for eyebrows.

NOSE: The bottom of your nose sits halfway between the tip of the nose and the chin. Draw bottom of the nose only. Shadows give nose its triangular shape. *Do not show nose and mouth poster and draw facial features as they are discussed.*



MOUTH: Line between lips is half-way between tip of nose and chin. Can draw just two lines, middle and bottom lip line. Some lips are full, some thin, but all have same general shape.



EARS: Extend from eyebrow line to end of nose!!! THEY ARE BIGGER THAN YOU THINK!



NECK: A sturdy, simple column

Each face you see is different and tells a different story. A drawing is not like a photograph. It needn't include every detail. Keep it simple. Sometimes just a few simple lines can suggest a lot.

(Give students a few minutes to complete their drawings.)

2. CONTINUOUS LINE DRAWING (tracing paper over laminated picture, 10 minutes)

Next, we will make Continuous Line Drawings of faces.

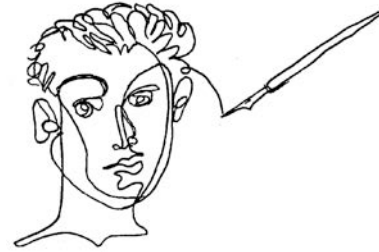
Again, a continuous line drawing is a common drawing exercise for artists as it trains the eye and hand to work as a team and helps the artist to see all of the details of the object. The premise of continuous line drawing is that the pen, pencil or another easy writing instrument never leaves the paper until you are done. (It differs from contour line drawing where additional lines can be added.) Obviously, this creates some challenges – lines double back on themselves and inevitably, you have to draw lines where you would prefer blank space – but this is the point.

Docent to tape laminated picture with tracing paper on the board. Do a continuous line drawing of the face with a WIDER FELT-TIP PEN, starting with the eyes. Explain to the students as you go that you are not going to lift the pen from the paper until the drawing is complete. Demonstrate how to double back.

Students do their continuous line drawings with fine-tip pens. Using your pens, make a continuous line drawing of your photograph on your own tracing paper. REMEMBER, you can cross back and forth over the lines, but the challenge is to NOT lift your pen off the tracing paper after beginning to draw. Double back rather than lift the pen. LOOK CLOSELY AND CAREFULLY. DRAW SLOWLY! This improves the free flow of your drawing. Start with the eyes and work outward.

3. CONTINUOUS LINE DRAWING #2 (page #2 of sketchbook, 10 minutes)

On the next right-hand page of your sketchbook, using the same picture, do a continuous line drawing of your photograph.



Docent to start a continuous line drawing.

- Move your hand at a similar speed in which you observe the subject with your eyes. This will help you to create more accurate proportions and shapes. But remember, perfection is not attainable.
- Draw slowly. No TALKING! This takes concentration.
- Start with the eyes and work out.
- Look back and forth between your photo and what you are actually drawing. DRAW WHAT YOU SEE!
- Draw hair as if each piece is actually part of one single line.

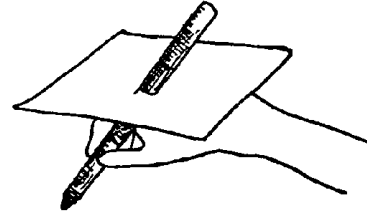
LOOK HARD AND CLOSE. LET YOUR EYE FOLLOW EVERY “IN” AND “OUT”. FOLLOW EVERY CURVE AND CONTOUR. GO EVER SO SLOWLY.

4. BLIND CONTINUOUS LINE DRAWING (page #3 of sketchbook, 5 minutes)

Our next drawing will be a Blind Continuous Line Drawing. In a blind line drawing, you “feel” the contours or edges of a figure without seeing what you are drawing. Drawing something without looking at your paper is a way to trick our minds into looking beyond what we expect to see. *Show example of blind continuous line drawing so students will have an idea of their final goal.*

Docent does not use a shield as it obstructs the students’ view. Instead, turn away from the board so the students can clearly see that you are not looking at the drawing. Hold photograph in opposite hand or tape on board so the students can glance at it as you work and demonstrate how to do a blind continuous line drawing.

Have parent volunteer or assistant pass out shields. While they are passing out the shields, demonstrate how to position the pen shield over a pen.



Push your pen through the paper square and grasp the pen UNDER the shield to keep your eyes off of your drawing. Make a blind continuous line drawing on the next right-hand page in your sketchbook.

DO NOT SHOW YOUR DRAWINGS TO ANYONE until we are all finished. Then we can take a look at all of the drawings together!

THIS IS A LESSON IN COURAGE!

As the students are working, walk around and make positive statements and suggestions:

- Pretend the pen is on the face you are drawing rather than on the paper.
- Start with the eyes and work out.
- Follow every curve and contour. CONCENTRATE!
- Remember this is a CONTINUOUS line drawing. Double back rather than lift the pen.
- Lines should be long, smooth and beautiful – no short strokes.
- The shapes may be strange but they will be fun to look at.

5. REFLECTION (10 minutes)

The first blind continuous line drawings are going to look strange to the students. Unless they are allowed an outlet for reacting after the first drawing, the classroom may become unruly. Assure the students that these first blind drawings will look strange BUT will also be very visually interesting. Some may even find them more so than the faces on the cover of their sketchbooks!

Once you have finished your blind drawing, quietly take a look at each of the things you have drawn so far today. Select a drawing you would like to display and let's put them up for a gallery walk for the class. Let's take a quiet walk around to see what others have created. Ask:

- What was the biggest challenge you encountered?
- What was your favorite exercise?
- Was this easier or harder than you expected?
- What changes would you make for improvement?

6. OPTIONAL CONTINUOUS LINE DRAWING OF A REAL PERSON (page #4 of sketchbook)

You have one more page in your sketchbook. I encourage you to try drawing another Continuous Line Drawing of a real person in the room, could be blind or not. You may draw me, your teacher, or someone sitting near you.

SUGGESTIONS FOR TEACHER:

1. Have students do 5 minutes of continuous-line or contour drawing each day. Draw anything in the classroom—a potted plant, shoe, desk, chair, etc. An extra challenge is to have them upside down so the student relies less on what they think the object looks like.
2. Have each student choose the drawing he/she feels was their most successful. Arrange all of the class portraits into a collage of faces.
3. Try the Art Docent's DIY "Write a Face" lesson <http://www.losaltosartdocents.org/docents/documents/DIY/WriteAFace.pdf>

BACKGROUND

PABLO PICASSO, 1881-1973 (Spanish)

Pablo Picasso, along with George Braque, developed the first abstract art form which was called Cubism. His art spans various styles from realism to abstraction in both two and three-dimensions. He contributed work to many of the major movements of the 20th century, particularly Fauvism, Cubism, Expressionism and Surrealism. His range of experimentation with ideas, techniques and materials is matched by few other artists. Françoise Gilot, an artist in her own right, was one of Picasso's mistresses and the mother of two of his children.

ROBERT DOISNEAU, 1912-1994 (French)

Robert Doisneau was a French photographer noted for his poetic approach to street photography. He is most famous for his 1950 photograph *Le Baiser de L'hôtel de Ville* (*Kiss by the Town Hall*) which pictures a couple kissing in the busy streets of Paris.

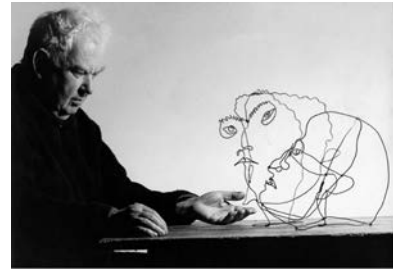


PAUL KLEE, 1879–1940 (German)

Paul Klee was a Swiss-German artist. His style was influenced by art that included Expressionism, Cubism and Surrealism. His works often had a childlike quality to them and were often small in scale since he had no formal studio, but worked at his kitchen table instead. He famously described line as, “A line is a dot that went for a walk.”

ALEXANDER CALDER, 1898–1976 (American)

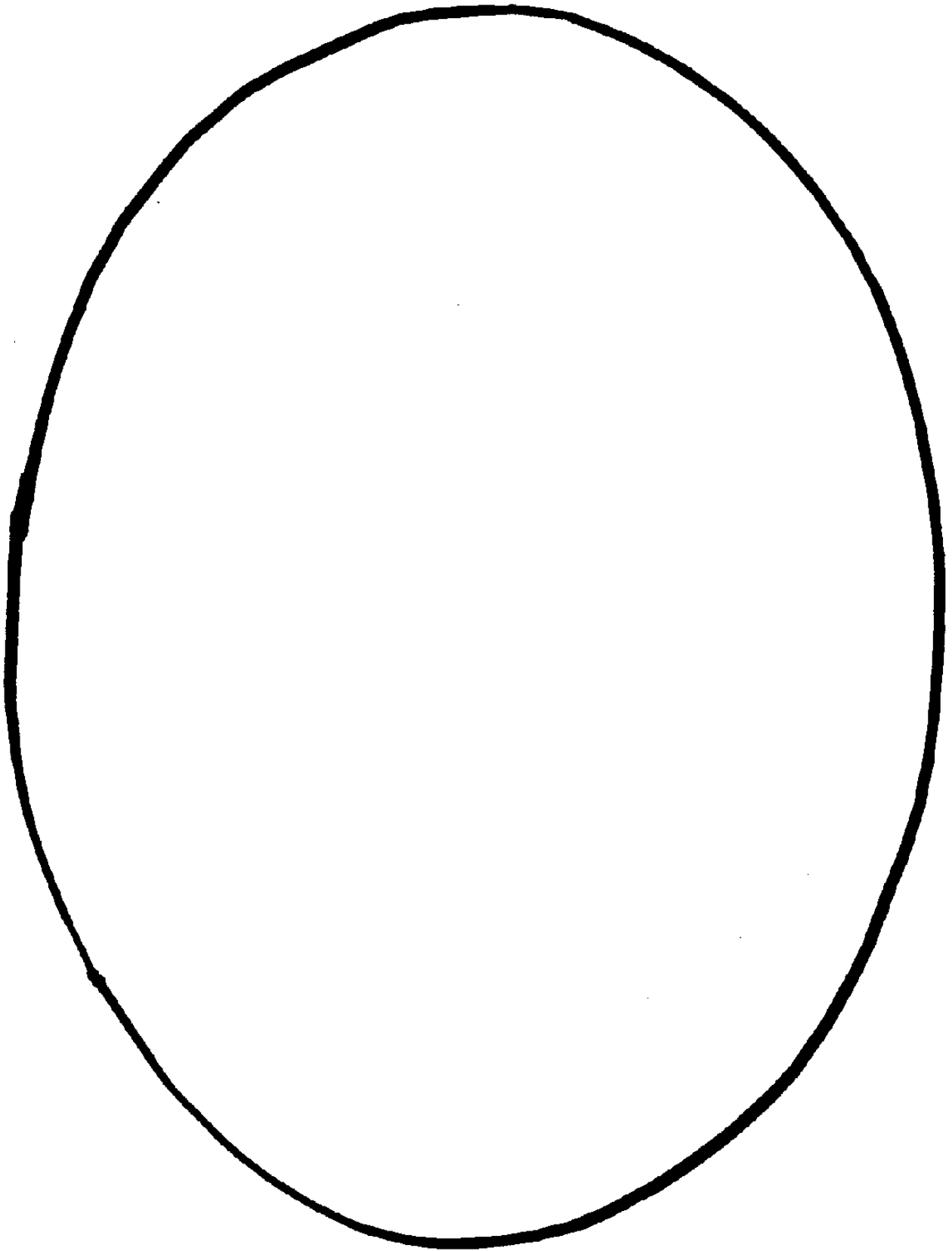
Alexander Calder was an American sculptor known as the originator of the mobile—a type of moving sculpture made with delicately balanced or suspended shapes that moved in response to touch and air currents. Calder was the first to use wire to create three-dimensional line “drawings” of people, animals and objects. These linear sculptures introduced line into sculpture as an element unto itself.



CHRISTOPHE LOUIS QUIBE, present (French)

Christophe Louis Quibe is a contemporary, French artist who specializes in continuous line illustrations. He strives for minimal abstract strokes. His motto is, “Simplicity isn't simple.”

Hiyao Miyazaki is a beloved, award-winning Japanese film director and animator known for films such as *Castle in the Sky*, *Ponyo* and *My Neighbor Totoro*.



Parent Instructions for Heads & Faces

Thank you for volunteering today!

Please help by:

Setting up lesson supplies

- Clear desks/tables
- Distribute drawing pad, felt-tip pen, oval template, and proportion of the head handout to each student.

During the lesson

- Listen carefully to the docent instructions to the students
- Students can easily become distracted between each drawing exercise, help calm students down for the next exercise
- Distribute laminated pictures with tracing paper attached to each student after the proportion drawing is finished



Additional tips

- Please don't work on students' art — demonstrate on scrap materials
- Ask Art Docents if a student needs extra help
- Let docent know if any felt-tip pens have dried out
- Have fun!

Helping clean-up

- Encourage students to clean up any mess and put away supplies
- Replace the used tracing paper with a new clean sheet for each photograph

LOS ALTOS



DOCENTS



Revision History

Revision Date	Docent Name	Comments
1977/78		Figure Drawing including contour and gesture drawing
1985	Dana James	Revised to Heads & Faces
September 2012	Kimberly Dickerson	Reformatted for continuity
October 2012	Vaishali Khandekar	Corrected Materials list
February 2013	Curriculum Committee	Added suggestions for docents to give feedback to children
May 2014	Committee led by Kristine Bardman	Added featured works, moved to 5 th grade
November 2017	Joan Takenaka	Added more emphasis on artists who use continuous line drawings and why
May 2019	Kimberly Dickerson	New VAPA Standards added
November 2023	Mira Sharma	Added proportions of head handout
June 2024	Curriculum Committee	Parent Volunteer Instructions Added